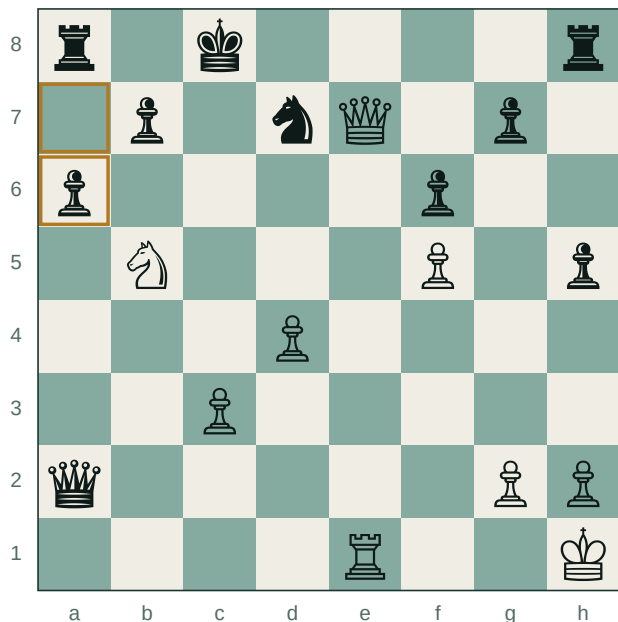


Queenside attacks: White, move 26

Queenside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 25...a6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Qe8+ Rxe8 27. Rxe8#

26.Qe8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e8 it attacks king on c8, rook on h8 and knight on d7.
Recorded reply: **26...Rxe8**.

27.Rxe8# Mate: rook on e8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The board's left half is not inherently safe. Queen checks and rook entries can make a queenside king as vulnerable as a kingside one.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An attack on the queenside can target a castled king, a vulnerable pawn, or trapped pieces. Files and entry squares matter more than simply advancing flank pawns.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the critical target and which pawn or piece move opens a route toward it. Check whether central counterplay interrupts the plan.

The defending king is on c8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.